



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Summit Christian Academies
School Website: <https://scaschools.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Summit Christian Academy (SCA) in Yorktown, VA shows a clearly classical Christian orientation across public materials and internal documents. The school consistently foregrounds a Christian worldview, integration of theology with academics, a Trivium-based curriculum, and a pedagogy built around memorization, disciplined inquiry, and rhetorical communication. Public materials emphasize partnership with families, a chapel-centered life, classical curriculum (grammar–dialectic–rhetoric), Latin, Great Books/the Great Conversation framing, and explicit affirmation of truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable. The school also highlights faculty leadership and a strong parent/community partnership, including open communication with families and parental involvement in school life. Taken together, these signals align strongly with classical education as described in the classical education rubric and associated keyword lexicon.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

- The religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit, with a Christ-centered worldview, theology integration, and chapel-like/community practices implied by the school's mission and chapel emphasis. Evidence: Vision and Mission statements foreground discernment of truth, faith articulation, and service within a Christian framework, along with a stated partnership with parents to educate through a Christian and classical education. The public narrative also emphasizes a biblical worldview and the centrality of God's Word in all subject areas. The school even articulates a chapel program alignment and theological formation as a core element of education.
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal) is CLASSICAL, with formation, virtue, wisdom, and a telos centered on truth, goodness, and beauty; public materials frame education as formation and the pursuit of lasting human excellence in a Christian view of wisdom. Strategic planning and mission/vision statements consistently describe formation of virtuous, able citizens through a classical Christian framework.
- Element 3 (Curriculum) is CLASSICAL. The Grammar School curriculum is explicitly described as classical (grammar stage, Latin in upper grammar, history and science taught "classically" with songs, chants, drill, and repetition), and the program references the Trivium and the later dialectic/rhetoric phases at the Upper School. This aligns with the traditional liberal-arts core and the Great Books/Great Conversation ethos common in classical education. The public materials outline Latin instruction and an integrated, historically informed curriculum that spans civics, geography, history, economics, and classical studies.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy) is CLASSICAL. The school explicitly emphasizes the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric), Socratic/dialectic discussion at the upper grades, and a pedagogy that includes singing, chanting, memorization, and oratory/rhetoric development. The school describes a logic-focused dialectic stage and a rhetoric stage with senior theses and public defense, consistent with classical pedagogy. It also notes chanting and memory work in younger grades as a core practice.
- Element 5 (Faculty) is CLASSICAL. The site presents a traditional, teacher-centered model with a "living curriculum" and a portrait of a teacher as a core part of the school identity; there are explicit references to long-standing faculty engagement, leadership, and a formal "Blue & Gold Society" rec-

ognizing veteran teachers. These signals align with the classical model's emphasis on model teachers, mentors, and the living curriculum.

- Element 6 (Parents & Community) is CLASSICAL. Summit explicitly presents a partnership with families, parental formation, and open campus visits, with ongoing engagement through blogs, book studies, and events designed to educate parents about classical education. The strategic plan also foregrounds parent involvement and community partnerships (e.g., capitalization of capital campaigns, grandparent events) as integral to the school's mission. The school's branding and communications emphasize "Discern | Articulate | Serve" and a family partnership in education, which aligns with the classical model's emphasis on family formation and parental co-educators.

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Vision and Mission foreground a Christian education centered on truth, faith, and service, with integration of scripture and theology across disciplines.
 - Public narratives emphasize a biblical worldview and the centrality of God's Word in all subject areas.
 - Chapel and liturgical cadence appear as ongoing communal practices through the school's culture and mission (chapel programming appears as alignment with mission).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (examples): truth, theology, chapel, biblical worldview, God's Word. These align with the lexicon's Positive Keywords for the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations.
 - Negative keywords: none observed in public materials.
- Why this rating
 - The materials consistently affirm transcendental moral realism (truth discernment within a Christian framework), a theology-grounded; liturgical/community life is integrated via chapel-like structures, and a sacred-culture tone pervades communications.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission and vision articulate formation of virtuous, wise human beings within a Christian and classical framework. The strategic plan emphasizes flourishing, virtuous life, and a pedagogy aligned with classical formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, classical mission, true/good/beautiful). The school's materials explicitly discuss formation, virtue, wisdom, and classical-teaching aims.
 - Negative keywords: none observed.
- Why this rating
 - The school's stated purposes center on formation and wisdom rather than mere workforce preparation, aligning with the Classical Tradition's telos and paideia ideals.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Grammar School curriculum is explicitly classical (Grammar, Latin, history, science taught classically; songs/ chants/ drill in instruction). Upper levels reference the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) and integration of classical studies.

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- Public materials describe Latin beginning in early grades and a broad classical curriculum extending through the upper grades (civics, geography, history, economics; classical studies).
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Great Books/Great Conversation framing, history as Western civilization). The site shows explicit Trivium terminology and Latin study.
 - Negative keywords: not observed in public materials; the curriculum emphasizes classical content rather than a social-studies-first framing.
 - Why this rating
 - The curriculum aligns with the classical canon: Trivium-based progression, Latin, and an integrated study of history and core disciplines within a classical framework.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school explicitly describes the Trivium model, with Grammar, Dialectic, and Rhetoric stages, including Socratic discourse, memory work, and rhetoric training (senior thesis, public defense).
 - Younger grades incorporate singing, chanting, memory exercises; upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion and debates; rhetoric skills are cultivated through speeches and theses.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (Socratic, dialectic, rhetoric, memorization/recitation, scholé/wonder, liturgical memory, public speaking). These map to the Positive Keywords in the Pedagogy section of the lexicon.
 - Negative keywords: no reliance on exclusively experiential or project-based pedagogy; the approach remains rooted in classical method.
- Why this rating
 - The pedagogy centers on classical methods (Socratic dialogue, memorization, rhetoric) and an intentional progression from grammar to dialectic to rhetoric, with explicit high-school-level rhetoric instructions and senior-thesis evaluation.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site presents faculty as core to the school's mission and "living curriculum." There are references to formal faculty recognition (The Blue & Gold Society) and a long-term emphasis on professional development and mentoring within the school community.
 - The public materials emphasize a culture of mentorship and a portrait of what teachers should be, with a tradition of long-tenured service and faculty leadership.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, mentorship). These correspond to the lexicon's description of the classical faculty, including a "portrait of a teacher" and "living curriculum."
 - Negative keywords: none observed.
- Why this rating
 - Summit frames teachers as central to formation and to the curriculum, aligning with the classical educators' model of virtuous, learned mentors and a "living curriculum."

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Summit emphasizes a partnership with parents as co-educators and constructs parents as integral to the classical education process, with parent formation and open campus participation. The strategic plan and communications describe ongoing parent engagement and family formation activities.

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- Public materials describe parental involvement in capital campaigns, school events (e.g., Grandparents Day), and opportunities to engage with the curriculum (book studies, gatherings).
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, openness to visits, home-school alignment, family formation). These map to the Positive Keywords in the Parents & Community section of the lexicon.
 - Negative keywords: there is no evident consumerist or customer-service framing; instead, parental involvement is positioned as forming virtue and shared mission.
 - Why this rating
 - The school presents a robust, ongoing parental-partnership model, with parents actively engaged in formation and school life, which aligns with the classical model's emphasis on family engagement and parental co-education.

What Would Move the Needle (not applicable here)

- Because the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL, this section is not required. If you'd like, I can propose needle-moving refinements in a future pass (e.g., explicit articulation of Great Books lists, more formal documentation of a campus-wide liturgical rhythm, or additional publicly accessible statements about Great Conversations).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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